Board verdict

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE: A founder wants to invest $10,000 in a private-label accessories brand made by a manufacturer in Thailand and sold internationally.

Session example-thailand-accessories | Mode: startup

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Postpone

Weighted overall score 5.1/10

Board confidence 54% (subjective, not a calibrated probability)

The model works on the founder inputs, but demand, unit cost and trademark protection are untested while all of the capital is exposed. Test demand with a pre-sale before the first production run.

BUSINESS PROPOSAL

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE: A founder wants to invest $10,000 in a private-label accessories brand made by a manufacturer in Thailand and sold internationally.

Options considered: Launch now with $10,000 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide | Do nothing

RESEARCH FINDINGS

Illustrative placeholder. No live research was run for this example, so no market statistic is claimed. In a real session the Research Agent fills this with cited, dated findings.

[UNAVAILABLE] Unit cost, MOQ and lead time were not researched in this example
[ASSUMPTION] Selling price of $20 and 400 units a month are the founder inputs used in the model
[UNAVAILABLE] Competitor pricing was not researched in this example

Information not found:

1. Competitor prices
2. Manufacturer MOQ and lead time
3. Import duties by destination
4. Trademark status in target markets

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS

Metric	Optimistic	Expected	Pessimistic
Gross revenue	120,000	96,000	57,600
Cost of goods sold	43,200	38,400	27,648
Gross profit	76,800	57,600	29,952
Operating profit	49,200	30,720	3,624
Net profit	49,200	30,720	3,624
Gross margin	64%	60%	52%
Net margin	41%	32%	6.29%
ROI over horizon	392%	207.2%	-63.76%
Break-even units / month	164	175	209
Capital recovered	month 3	month 4	never
Peak funding need	10,000	10,000	10,000

Horizon 12 months. Amounts in the user's currency.

Financial assumptions

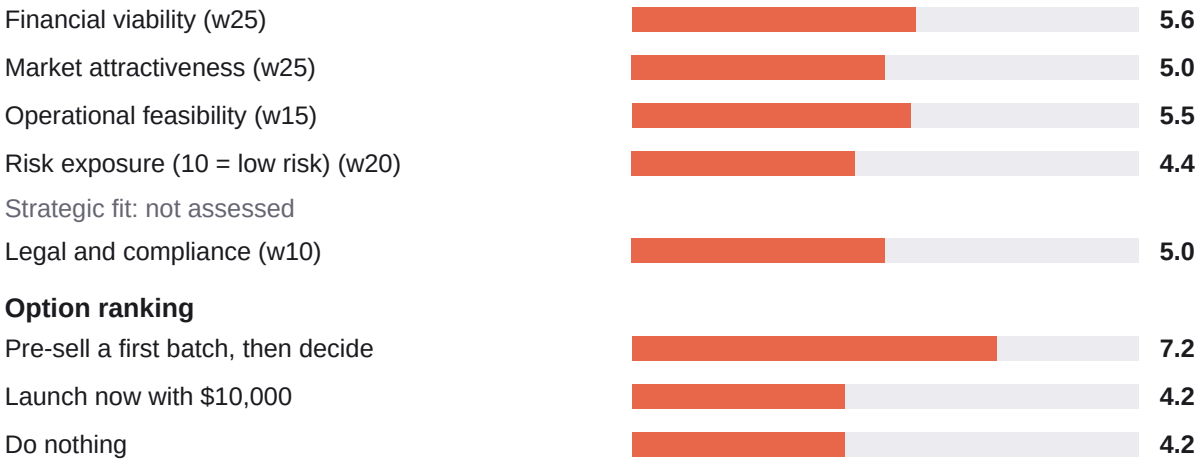
1. All optional inputs were supplied by the user.

Optimistic and pessimistic scenarios use default stress multipliers that are assumptions, not research findings.

Model limitations

1. No working-capital or inventory-timing model: stock bought before sales is not modelled, so early cash need is understated for product businesses.
2. Tax is applied to positive monthly operating profit only; losses are not carried forward.
3. Units grow at a constant monthly rate; no seasonality, no churn, no price changes over time.
4. Currency conversion, shipping, duties and returns must already be inside the unit cost or fixed costs.

SCOREBOARD AND CRITERIA



Option ranking

HOW THE BOARD REACHED ITS CONCLUSION

1. Weighted overall 5.1/10 across 5 of 6 criteria (95% of weight assessed); not assessed: Strategic fit.
2. Financial viability: 5.6/10 at weight 25 (seats: fin, procure).
3. Market attractiveness: 5/10 at weight 25 (seats: market, trade).
4. Operational feasibility: 5.5/10 at weight 15 (seats: trade, procure).
5. Risk exposure (10 = low risk): 4.4/10 at weight 20 (seats: legal, riskmgr).
6. Legal and compliance: 5/10 at weight 10 (seats: legal).
7. Score 5.1 maps to "Postpone" using thresholds proceed>=7, conditional>=5.5, postpone>=4.
8. No caps applied.
9. Board confidence 54% (subjective; see factors).

MAIN COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGES

1. Healthy gross margin on the stated inputs (60%)

CRITICAL WEAKNESSES

1. No evidence of demand
2. Unit cost is an input, not a quotation
3. No working-capital model

TOP RISKS

1. Failed first batch

2. Trademark conflict
3. Freight and duty costs above plan

MAIN DISAGREEMENTS BETWEEN ADVISORS

1. Financial Department sees payback inside the year; Risk Management sees the whole capital exposed to one batch

---

DEVIL'S ADVOCATE

Formal objection (blocking)

Demand, unit cost and trademark ownership are all unproven, and the whole $10,000 is committed before any of them is tested. A single failed batch ends the venture.

To withdraw this objection:

1. Obtain at least 3 written manufacturer quotations
2. Pre-sell or waitlist at least 50 units before the first production run
3. Register the brand in the first target market

Alternatives suggested:

1. Order a small sample batch first
2. Sell through one marketplace before building a store

Alternative strategies

1. Sample batch first
2. One marketplace before a store

REQUIRED CONDITIONS BEFORE IMPLEMENTATION

1. Obtain at least 3 written manufacturer quotations
2. Pre-sell or waitlist at least 50 units before the first production run
3. Register the brand in the first target market

NEXT STEPS

1. Request 3 RFQs this week
2. Open a waitlist and target 50 pre-orders
3. File the trademark in the first market

WHAT-IF SCENARIOS

Sales 40% lower

unitsPerMonth: 400 to 240

Expected net profit 30,720 to 8,832. Recommendation: Postpone (5.1) to Postpone (4.7).

ADVISOR EVALUATIONS

The Financial Department (weight 5)

financial: 6

Launch now with $10,000: 5 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 8 | Do nothing: 4

Pays back in the expected case; working capital is not modelled.

Market Intelligence Department (weight 4)

market: 5

Launch now with $10,000: 5 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 7 | Do nothing: 3

No demand evidence yet.

International Trade Department (weight 3)

operational: 6 | market: 5

Launch now with $10,000: 4 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 7 | Do nothing: 3

Duties and freight unresearched.

Legal and Compliance Department (weight 3)

legal: 5 | risk: 5

Launch now with $10,000: 4 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 7 | Do nothing: 5

Trademark and supplier contract unaddressed.

Risk Management Department (weight 4)

risk: 4

Launch now with $10,000: 3 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 7 | Do nothing: 6

Whole capital committed to one untested batch.

Negotiation and Procurement Department (weight 3)

operational: 5 | financial: 5

Launch now with $10,000: 4 | Pre-sell a first batch, then decide: 7 | Do nothing: 4

No quotations in hand.

DEBATE TRANSCRIPT

Round 1: Opening positions

The Financial Department

On the founder inputs the expected case repays the $10,000 in about five months, but the model has no working capital. Paying a manufacturer before selling a unit means the real cash need is above $10,000. The pessimistic case barely breaks even.

Negotiation and Procurement Department

Nobody has quoted a unit cost. The $8 is an input, not a quotation. Get three RFQs with MOQ, payment terms and incoterms before committing.

SOURCE REFERENCES

No external sources were cited.

This report is general AI-assisted analysis, not financial, investment or qualified legal advice. Verify material facts independently.